

Section A (Spoken response)

For this section:

- students identify in advance **two** out of the four GTAs that they wish their discussion to be based on; they will only be assessed on **one** of these GTAs during the examination
- students should inform the teacher/examiner no more than three weeks in advance of the assessment which two GTAs they have selected via an *Oral topic form (OR1)*
- a number of different stimulus cards will be produced by Pearson for each of the four GTAs: these will be issued on a random-allocation basis following the order prescribed by Pearson – the teacher/examiner does not choose the order of the cards. The sequencing grid will appear in the Instructions to the teacher/examiner booklet for each series.
- the teacher/examiner will give the student a stimulus card based on one of the subtopics from the student's **two** chosen GTAs
- each stimulus card will contain two short paragraphs on a subtopic
- students will have 15 minutes to prepare for this section, during which they can make notes that they can refer to during their discussion (maximum of one side of A4 paper)
- the assessment for Section A will start immediately after the 15 minutes' preparation time so students can recall their prepared thoughts easily
- students have approximately four minutes' discussion time for this section.